

US Tells AI Company Anthropic: No Foreigners Can Use Your Smartest Models!

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What if the smartest computer brain in the world could only be used by people from one country? That's kind of what just happened! The US government told a company called **Anthropic** to stop letting anyone from outside the US use its two newest AI models. These models, named **Fable 5** and **Mythos 5**, are like super-advanced chatbots that can write, code, and solve really hard problems. The government says this is to keep the country safe. They worry that if the wrong people get access, they could use the AI to do bad things like **cyberattacks** that's when hackers break into computer systems. Some reports say the government thinks a group linked to China may have gotten into the AI. **Anthropic** is not happy. They say the government only gave them "**verbal evidence**" of a small problem, not a big danger. The company believes pulling the models away from millions of users is too extreme. This fight is part of a bigger argument. Earlier, the US put **Anthropic** on a **blacklist** because the company refused to let the military use its AI for spying on people inside the US or for weapons that can attack on their own. Now, with this new order, **Anthropic** had to quickly turn off **Fable 5** and **Mythos 5** for all customers, even Americans, just to make sure no foreign person could use them. Other AI companies like OpenAI have similar powerful models but haven't faced such strict rules. Experts say these AI tools could help hackers break into banks or power grids if they fall into the wrong hands. But **Anthropic** says it already worked with the government on safety before releasing the models. It's a tough balance: keeping cool tech safe while still letting people use it for good.

Word Treasure

Anthropic -- Anthropic is a company that builds extremely smart AI computer programs.

Fable 5 -- Fable 5 is the name of one of Anthropic's newest and most powerful AI models.

Mythos 5 -- Mythos 5 is another advanced AI model created by Anthropic.

cyberattacks -- Cyberattacks happen when hackers break into computers or networks to steal information or cause damage.

verbal evidence -- Verbal evidence means information that is spoken aloud, not written down or recorded.

blacklist -- A blacklist is a list that bans certain people or companies from using something or being part of a deal.

Background you need

AI, or artificial intelligence, is technology that lets computers learn and solve problems a bit like humans do.

Anthropic is an American company known for building safe and powerful chatbots -- similar to a super-smart virtual assistant.

The US government often checks powerful new tech to make sure it doesn't fall into the hands of spies or hackers, especially from countries like China.

Break it down

WHO: The US government and the AI company Anthropic.

WHAT: The government ordered Anthropic to block anyone outside the US from using its two newest AI models, Fable 5 and Mythos 5.

WHERE: This decision came from the United States and affects users all around the world.

WHY: The government feared that foreign groups, possibly linked to China, could use the AI for cyberattacks, so it acted to protect national security.

Why it matters

The tools you might use for homework or games one day need to be kept safe, just like a powerful secret, so they aren't used to break important systems that keep our world running.

Test what you remember

1. What are the names of the two AI models the US government banned from foreign use?
 - (A) Fable 5 and Mythos 5
 - (B) ChatGPT and Claude
 - (C) Anthropic 1 and 2
 - (D) Gemini and Gemini Pro
2. Why did the government order this ban?
 - (A) To make money for the US
 - (B) To stop cyberattacks and keep the country safe
 - (C) Because China asked them to do it
 - (D) To help Anthropic sell more models
3. What did Anthropic say about the government's evidence?
 - (A) They had written proof
 - (B) They gave only verbal evidence of a small problem
 - (C) They gave no evidence at all
 - (D) They used fake documents
4. Why did the US put Anthropic on a blacklist earlier?
 - (A) Because its AI was too slow
 - (B) Because it refused to let the military use AI for spying or autonomous weapons
 - (C) Because it made a coding mistake
 - (D) Because it worked with China
5. According to experts, what could hackers do with these powerful AI tools?
 - (A) Help students learn math
 - (B) Break into banks or power grids
 - (C) Play professional chess
 - (D) Write poems
6. What did Anthropic do right after the new order?
 - (A) They moved to another country
 - (B) They turned off the models for all customers, including Americans
 - (C) They immediately sued the government
 - (D) They sold the models to China

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: B 3: B 4: B 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

- 1. Government Official:** Officials believe blocking foreign access is necessary to stop spies and hackers from using the AI to attack banks or steal secrets, even if it upsets users.
- 2. Anthropic's View:** The company thinks the ban is too extreme because the government only provided spoken reports of a small issue, not strong proof of widespread danger.
- 3. Privacy Advocate:** Some people are concerned that the earlier blacklist for refusing military spying shows the government is pushing tech companies into surveillance, not just security.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):